BILINGUAL HELPLINE SETUP — STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

It took me 16 hours to learn this creation path. As no one knew how to work this system, so I had to learn telephone configuration from scratch.
I figured this might help another by laying it out step-by-step for those that are not accustomed to intense telephone configurations.

STEP-BY-STEP 1
PHASE ONE 1
NOW FOR THE SECOND LANGUAGE 3
PHASE TWO 5
PHASE THREE 5
MOST IMPORTANT THING OF ALL 6
PHASE FOUR 7
VOICE RECORDINGS 7

To Start:

Sign into your Yap account
https://bmlt.wszf.org/yap/

Go to the tab "Service Bodies"
https://bmlt.wszf.org/yap/admin/service-bodies

STEP-BY-STEP

PHASE ONE

Then choose the Button "Configure"

From the drop down menu named "**Configure Precedence**" choose the following in order:
config
Then enter **your Phone Line Number** (the one the public calls for NA help)

1. Then **save changes**.
2. Click the Button "Configure"
3. From the drop down menu named "Configure Precedence" choose:

(Those three actions will be called "**save & add**")

IMPORTANT: yes it adds more time to save and add between each step. But Yap will log you out without warning and you will lose whatever is not saved without warning.

phone_number_validation
Enter: **US**

Save & add.

twilio_account_sid
Enter the **Account SID** from your home page at
https://1console.twilio.com/account/
It will look like, for example: APRT3huhoojn7987hbjhb

Save & add.

twilio_auth_token
Enter the **Auth Token** from your home page at
https://1console.twilio.com/account/
(Click the eye icon to reveal)
It will look like, for example: 7s987dv9as87fv7ts78ssvf778687

Save & add.

helpline_fallback
Enter a **second number** if you have it or enter the **same number from config** above.

Save & add.

fallback_number
Enter a **second number** if you have it or enter the **same number from config** above.

Save & add.

call_routing_filter
Enter a **second number** if you have it or enter the **same number from config** above.

Save & add.

title
Enter **Your Area Name**

Save & add.

en_US_voice
Choose **Polly.Kendra**

Save & add.

NOW FOR THE SECOND LANGUAGE

Choose the non-English language you need, for example Spanish would be:

es_US_voice
Choose **Polly.Pedro** or choose **Polly.Penelope**

Save & add.

jft_option
Enter **true**

Save & add.

en_US_greeting
Add the voice url (see below under Voice Recordings)

Save & add.

es_US_greeting
Add the voice url (see below under Voice Recordings)

Save & add.

en_US_voicemail_greeting
Add the voice url (see below under Voice Recordings)

Save & add.

sms_dialback_options
Enter **2**

Save & add.

sms_summary_page
Enter **true**

Save & add.

es_US_voicemail_greeting
Add the voice url (see below under Voice Recordings)

Save & add.

language_selections
Enter **en-US,es-US**
(Or whatever second language you choose)

Save & add.

language_selections_greeting
Add the voice url (see below under Voice Recordings)

Save & add.

language_selections_tagging
(Leave empty)

Save & add.

language
Enter **es-US**

Save & add.

Halfway to home.

PHASE TWO

While still on the Service Bodies page
Now click the **button "Call Handling"**

Helpline Routing:
Choose "Volunteers"
Forced Caller Id (Must Be A Verified Twilio Number):
Enter Your main public help line for NA
Call Timeout (default: 20 seconds):
If you want to change, type in the number of second and the word seconds, for example 30 seconds
Gender Routing:
Choose: **disabled** or **enabled**
Call Strategy:
Choose: **Blasting, Then Voicemail**
Inbound call SMS to Volunteer Options:
Choose: **Send SMS to Volunteer**
Primary Contact Number (typically the Chair/Coordinator):
Enter their **phone** (optional is fine without it)
Primary Contact Email (typically the Chair/Coordinator):
Enter their **email** (we send to our webmaster)

If you are going to follow the below voice recordings or enter something else in **Configure** then **leave the last three fields empty.**

SAVE CHANGES

PHASE THREE

Now go to

The tab "**Groups**"

In the drop down menu "**Service Bodies**"
Select the name of your service body

"**Groups**"
Click the button **Create**
Name (required):
Name it e.g., **English Volunteers**

Shared With Service Bodies (optional):
Your Area should be there.
Click **OK**

Second language
Click the button **Create**
Name (required):
Name it e.g., **Spanish Volunteers**
Shared With Service Bodies (optional):
Your Area should be there.
Click **OK**

Click on the drop down under "Groups"
Select the first group of names and phone numbers to enter.
Click **Add Volunteer**
In the field **Volunteer Name**
Enter **the first name of person**
Click **+** next to their name.
Phone Number:
Enter **their phone number**
Gender:
Click and choose **male** or **female** or leave it **unassigned**
Responder:
Click and choose "**assigned**"

You can assign all the time, every day, or specific shifts.
Add Shift
Assign the times
NOTE: If someone is doing a 6pm to 6am shift, you have to choose the day, for example: Tuesday then 6:00PM to 11:59PM then save, then add shift again, Wednesday then 12:00AM to 6:00AM

Enabled
Click the box

MOST IMPORTANT THING OF ALL

Next to **Languages**
You will see **en-US** and **es-US** (or whichever was your second language)
Just **click** that **language** that person speaks **so it's highlighted** and then press **save volunteers.**

That is how you assign them a language.

Go through each volunteer in English and add them as above. Then do the same for each for your second language group.

PHASE FOUR

Next go to the tab "**Volunteers**"

Click **Include Group**

Select **the Group You just created**.
Click **Save Volunteers**

Click **Include Group**
Select **the Second Language Group You just created**.
Click **Save Volunteers**

Congratulations. You're done.

VOICE RECORDINGS

Our 11th Tradition is concerned with one individual being the voice of NA. So in our Area we use AI voices.

Create a Free Google Cloud Account for Vertex AI now called Agent Studio
https://console.cloud.google.com/freetrial

You get 90 days for **free**.
You get $300 **free** credits to use in 90 days. They ask for a credit card but won't charge you.
Enter an email to signup
Once signed up:
Come back and copy and paste this or click it:
https://console.cloud.google.com/agent-platform/studio/media/speech

On the right side you can leave it on preset
Text to Speech
Gemini 3.1 Flash TTS

In the field, "**Style Instructions**"
Give it the NA vibe.
Enter prompts like: Warm and inviting tone, like you are hugging them with your voice.
Then under **Voice**
Choose and play with them.
I have found that Aoede is cool, but I really like Leda and Laomedeia for female voices. If you want a Black accent you can try Zephyr or Gacrux. But Zephyr is my favorite.

Test them out with a short simple sentence.
"Welcome to narcotics anonymous, gold coast area. We're here to help."
Or enter your Area name. That creates fast samples that are consistent.

In the bottom field enter your text.
TIPS: It's already pretty good but you can adjust it:
A Capital letter tells it to pause just a tiny fraction. Periods are longer pauses, commas are middle ground. A new line does it too. Play around.
Then to generate click the arrow thing next to your text.

Click play.
If you like it click **Export**.
I download all of them, unless it was junk.

Once you sampled and found the one you like, try **Parameters**
Leave **Linear16**
Sample rate of **22050** Hz is less data, which might be better for your phone lines. Or 44100 Hz is much richer, but more data. You should avoid 8000 Hz unless needed.

Speed is useful. Try .95 or .90 to slightly slow it. Or .80 to make is speak slower but not annoying slow. You can speed it up to 1.1.
This is not speed like chipmunk or slow like distorted. It's just talking faster or more slowly.
Volume gain is fine at 0 or 3 to 5 is good.

It will export as a .wav file, but you will need it to be an mp3 file.
https://www.freeconvert.com/wav-to-mp3
Click the link above.

Click **Choose Files** and select the **WAV recording downloaded** from Google.
Click **Convert to MP3**.
Once finished, click **Download MP3**.
Name it something simple:
English-menu.mp3
Or
Spanish-menu.mp3
Then upload it to your Area website in the media library and copy the url then paste it above in the sections noted and save it.

When you switch to your second language, that is under **Language**.

TIPS: Be sensitive to the culture you are translating for. In English female voices tend to convey trust. But in Spanish, male voices tend to convey trust.

Below are scripts that we used. We vetted them to get the language and spacing just right. Feel free to use them and adjust to your area name.
Also, each created sample will be slightly different, so you can just keep hitting generate then export each time and make a few, then listen to all of them for the one your team likes best.

I then put them into a video editor and mix and splice if needed. Or just do the conversion to mp3 above.

Our end product starts with:
We're here to help.
For English press one.
Para español, oprima el número dos.

TIPS: You can create the above in the same run, it knows how to speak both languages separately.
For that intro we just let it be a female Spanish voice.

Here's the English script we arrived at:
Welcome to narcotics anonymous, gold coast area. We're here to help.
To speak to someone, press one.
To find a meeting, press two.
To listen to just for today, press three.
For more information, Visit our website NA Ventura county dot com.

And our Spanish version:
Gracias por llamar a Narcóticos Anónimos, Área Gold Coast. Estamos aquí para ayudarle.
Si desea hablar con alguien en español, presione uno.
Si desea encontrar una reunión en español, presione dos.
Si desea escuchar Solo por Hoy, presione tres.
Para más información, visite nuestro sitio web N A Ventura County punto com.

Our Voicemail

It looks like our volunteer wasn't able to answer the phone. If you'd like, you can leave us a message, try calling back later, or visit our website at NA Ventura County dot com. There you'll find meeting info and more, plus our email is at the bottom of every page. Take care, and keep coming back.

Parece que nuestro voluntario no pudo contestar la llamada.
Si lo desea, puede dejarnos un mensaje, intentar de nuevo más tarde, o visitar nuestro sitio web en N A Ventura County punto com.
Allí encontrará información sobre reuniones y más, y nuestro correo electrónico está al final de cada página.
Cuídese, y siga regresando.

Thank you for letting me be of service.